

PANTRYCHEF

Recipe Knowledge Base

RAG Knowledge Source for the Recipe Preparation Agent (IBM watsonx.ai + Granite)

107 Recipes

Covering Indian, South Indian, Indo-Chinese, Chinese, Italian, Thai, Mexican, Mediterranean, American & Fusion cuisines
Vegetarian · Vegan · Gluten-Free · Dairy-Free · Non-Vegetarian tagged

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Schema & Usage Notes

Knowledge source for Recipe Preparation Agent RAG pipeline. Each object is one retrievable document/chunk. Embed the 'embedding_text' field using watsonx.ai embeddings (e.g., slate-125m-english-rtrvr) and store the full object as metadata for retrieval-augmented generation with IBM Granite.

Field Reference

- **id:** unique recipe identifier
- **title:** recipe name
- **cuisine:** cuisine category
- **diet_tags:** array of applicable diet tags
- **core_ingredients:** essential ingredients required
- **optional_ingredients:** ingredients that enhance but aren't essential
- **common_substitutions:** map of ingredient -> possible substitute(s)
- **prep_time_minutes:** estimated prep time
- **cook_time_minutes:** estimated cook time
- **servings:** default servings
- **instructions:** ordered step-by-step instructions
- **cooking_tips:** array of helpful tips
- **embedding_text:** flattened text used to generate the vector embedding for retrieval

R001 · Vegetable Pulao

Indian | *vegetarian, vegan, gluten-free, dairy-free*

Prep / Cook Time: 15 min prep, 25 min cook

Servings: 4

Core Ingredients

- rice
- mixed vegetables
- onion
- whole spices
- oil

Optional Ingredients

- ghee
- cashews
- peas
- mint

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
ghee	vegetable oil
cashews	peanuts or omit

Instructions

1. Soak rice for 20 minutes.
2. Heat oil, add whole spices until fragrant.
3. Add onion, saute until golden.
4. Add vegetables, saute 3-4 minutes.
5. Add rice, water (1:2), salt; bring to boil.
6. Cover, simmer 15-18 minutes.
7. Fluff and garnish before serving.

Cooking Tips

- Soaking rice prevents breakage.
- Avoid over-stirring to prevent mushiness.

R002 · Paneer Fried Rice

Indo-Chinese | *vegetarian*

Prep / Cook Time: 10 min prep, 15 min cook

Servings: 3

Core Ingredients

- cooked rice
- paneer
- capsicum
- spring onion
- soy sauce
- garlic

Optional Ingredients

- carrot
- sesame oil

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
paneer	tofu or potato cubes
soy sauce	tamari
capsicum	cabbage

Instructions

8. Shallow fry paneer cubes; set aside.
9. Saute garlic and onion whites on high flame.
10. Add chopped vegetables, stir-fry 2 minutes.
11. Add cold rice and soy sauce, toss on high heat.
12. Add fried paneer, garnish with spring onion.

Cooking Tips

- Use day-old rice for best texture.
- Cook on high flame for smoky flavor.

R003 · Tomato Onion Rice

South Indian | vegetarian, vegan, gluten-free

Prep / Cook Time: 10 min prep, 20 min cook

Servings: 3

Core Ingredients

- rice
- tomato
- onion
- garlic
- mustard seeds
- curry leaves

Optional Ingredients

- peanuts
- green chili

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
curry leaves	bay leaf or omit
mustard seeds	cumin seeds

Instructions

13. Cook rice and cool.
14. Heat oil, splutter mustard seeds and curry leaves.
15. Saute onion and garlic until translucent.
16. Add tomatoes, cook until soft.
17. Add spices and salt, mix in rice.

Cooking Tips

- Mash tomatoes for a richer base.
- Great use for slightly stale rice.

R004 · Curd Rice

South Indian | *vegetarian, gluten-free***Prep / Cook Time:** 5 min prep, 5 min cook**Servings:** 2**Core Ingredients**

- cooked rice
- yogurt
- mustard seeds
- curry leaves

Optional Ingredients

- pomegranate
- cucumber
- green chili

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
curd	dairy-free yogurt
curry leaves	omit

Instructions

18. Mash warm rice slightly.
19. Mix in curd and a little milk.
20. Temper mustard seeds and curry leaves in oil.
21. Pour tempering over rice, mix, season with salt.

Cooking Tips

- Mix curd into warm (not hot) rice for best texture.
- Ideal for leftover rice.

R005 · Lemon Rice

South Indian | *vegetarian, vegan, gluten-free***Prep / Cook Time:** 10 min prep, 15 min cook**Servings:** 3**Core Ingredients**

- cooked rice
- lemon
- mustard seeds
- curry leaves
- peanuts

- turmeric

Optional Ingredients

- green chili
- ginger

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
peanuts	cashews or omit
curry leaves	omit

Instructions

- Heat oil, splutter mustard seeds, curry leaves, and peanuts.
- Add turmeric and green chili.
- Add cooked rice, mix well.
- Turn off heat, squeeze in lemon juice, toss and serve.

Cooking Tips

- Add lemon juice off the heat to preserve its fresh flavor.

R006 · Egg Fried Rice

Chinese | *non-vegetarian*

Prep / Cook Time: 10 min prep, 15 min cook

Servings: 3

Core Ingredients

- cooked rice
- eggs
- spring onion
- soy sauce
- garlic

Optional Ingredients

- peas
- carrot
- sesame oil

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
soy sauce	tamari
spring onion	regular onion

Instructions

- Scramble eggs lightly, set aside.
- Saute garlic, add vegetables, stir-fry.
- Add rice and soy sauce, toss on high heat.
- Fold in scrambled eggs, garnish and serve.

Cooking Tips

- Cook eggs separately for distinct fluffy pieces.

R007 · Khichdi

Indian | *vegetarian, gluten-free*

Prep / Cook Time: 10 min prep, 25 min cook

Servings: 3

Core Ingredients

- rice
- split moong dal
- turmeric
- cumin seeds
- ghee

Optional Ingredients

- mixed vegetables
- ginger

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
ghee	oil for vegan version
moong dal	masoor dal

Instructions

30. Wash rice and dal together.
31. Heat ghee, temper cumin seeds.
32. Add vegetables and turmeric, saute briefly.
33. Add rice-dal mix and water, pressure cook 3-4 whistles.
34. Serve hot with a dollop of ghee.

Cooking Tips

- A comforting one-pot meal, great when unwell or for using leftover vegetables.

R008 · Vegetable Fried Quinoa

International | *vegan, vegetarian, gluten-free*

Prep / Cook Time: 10 min prep, 15 min cook

Servings: 3

Core Ingredients

- cooked quinoa
- mixed vegetables
- garlic
- soy sauce

Optional Ingredients

- tofu
- sesame seeds

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
quinoa	rice or couscous
soy sauce	tamari

Instructions

35. Saute garlic and vegetables in oil.
36. Add cooked quinoa, soy sauce, toss well.
37. Garnish with sesame seeds and serve.

Cooking Tips

- Quinoa is a high-protein substitute for rice in stir-fries.

R009 · Jeera Rice

Indian | *vegetarian, vegan, gluten-free*

Prep / Cook Time: 5 min prep, 20 min cook

Servings: 3

Core Ingredients

- rice
- cumin seeds
- ghee
- bay leaf

Optional Ingredients

- coriander leaves

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
ghee	oil

Instructions

38. Heat ghee, add cumin seeds and bay leaf until fragrant.
39. Add soaked rice and water, bring to boil.
40. Cover and simmer until cooked.
41. Fluff and garnish with coriander.

Cooking Tips

- Simple side dish that pairs with any curry.

R010 · Vegetable Biryani

Indian | *vegetarian, gluten-free*

Prep / Cook Time: 20 min prep, 35 min cook

Servings: 4

Core Ingredients

- rice
- mixed vegetables
- yogurt
- biryani masala
- onion
- mint

Optional Ingredients

- saffron
- cashews

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
yogurt	coconut milk for vegan
biryani masala	garam masala + chili powder

Instructions

42. Fry onions until golden brown; set aside.
43. Marinate vegetables in yogurt and spices.
44. Par-cook rice with whole spices.
45. Layer rice and vegetable mixture in a pot.
46. Top with fried onions and mint, cover tightly and cook on low heat (dum) for 20 minutes.

Cooking Tips

- The 'dum' slow-cooking step is key to authentic flavor.
- Layering evenly ensures balanced taste in every bite.

R011 · Dal Tadka

Indian | *vegetarian, gluten-free*

Prep / Cook Time: 10 min prep, 30 min cook

Servings: 4

Core Ingredients

- yellow lentils
- onion
- tomato
- garlic
- spices

Optional Ingredients

- ghee
- cumin seeds
- coriander

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
toor dal	moong or masoor dal
ghee	oil for vegan

Instructions

47. Pressure-cook lentils with turmeric until soft.
48. Heat ghee, temper cumin, garlic, onion until golden.
49. Add tomatoes and spices, cook until oil separates.
50. Pour tempering over dal, simmer 5 minutes.
51. Garnish with coriander.

Cooking Tips

- Mash dal slightly for creamier texture.
- A separate tempering (tadka) boosts aroma.

R012 · Chana Masala

Indian | *vegetarian, vegan, gluten-free*

Prep / Cook Time: 15 min prep, 30 min cook

Servings: 4

Core Ingredients

- chickpeas
- onion
- tomato
- garlic
- ginger
- spices

Optional Ingredients

- coriander leaves
- lemon

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
chickpeas	kidney beans
fresh tomato	tomato puree

Instructions

52. Saute onion, garlic, ginger until golden.
53. Add tomato and spices, cook until thick.
54. Add boiled/canned chickpeas and simmer 15 minutes.
55. Garnish with coriander and a squeeze of lemon.

Cooking Tips

- Mash a few chickpeas to thicken the gravy naturally.

R013 · Rajma Curry

Indian | *vegetarian, vegan, gluten-free*

Prep / Cook Time: 15 min prep, 35 min cook

Servings: 4

Core Ingredients

- kidney beans
- onion
- tomato
- garlic
- spices

Optional Ingredients

- cream
- coriander

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
kidney beans	black beans
cream	cashew paste or omit

Instructions

56. Soak and boil kidney beans until soft (or use canned).
57. Saute onion, garlic until golden.
58. Add tomato puree and spices, cook until thick.
59. Add boiled beans, simmer 15 minutes.
60. Garnish and serve.

Cooking Tips

- Simmering longer deepens the flavor of the gravy.

R014 · Palak Paneer

Indian | *vegetarian, gluten-free*

Prep / Cook Time: 15 min prep, 25 min cook

Servings: 3

Core Ingredients

- spinach
- paneer
- onion
- garlic
- cream

Optional Ingredients

- ginger
- garam masala

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
paneer	tofu
cream	cashew paste or milk

Instructions

61. Blanch spinach and blend into a puree.
62. Saute onion, garlic, ginger until golden.
63. Add spinach puree, spices, simmer 5 minutes.

64. Add paneer cubes and cream, cook 5 more minutes.

Cooking Tips

- Blanching spinach preserves its bright green color.

R015 · Butter Chicken

Indian | *non-vegetarian, gluten-free*

Prep / Cook Time: 20 min prep, 35 min cook

Servings: 4

Core Ingredients

- chicken
- tomato
- butter
- cream
- spices

Optional Ingredients

- cashews
- kasuri methi

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
cream	milk + butter
cashews	omit

Instructions

65. Marinate and cook chicken until charred/cooked through.
66. Prepare tomato-cashew gravy base, simmer until thick.
67. Add butter and cream, blend smooth if desired.
68. Add cooked chicken, simmer 10 minutes.
69. Finish with kasuri methi and a swirl of cream.

Cooking Tips

- Charring the chicken first adds smoky depth to the dish.

R016 · Egg Curry

Indian | *non-vegetarian, gluten-free, dairy-free*

Prep / Cook Time: 10 min prep, 25 min cook

Servings: 3

Core Ingredients

- boiled eggs
- onion
- tomato
- garlic
- spices

Optional Ingredients

- coconut milk
- coriander

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
coconut milk	cream or omit

Instructions

70. Saute onion, garlic until golden.
71. Add tomato and spices, cook until thick.
72. Add halved boiled eggs, simmer 10 minutes.
73. Garnish with coriander.

Cooking Tips

- Lightly frying boiled eggs before adding to curry improves texture.

R017 · Thai Green Curry

Thai | non-vegetarian, gluten-free, dairy-free

Prep / Cook Time: 15 min prep, 25 min cook

Servings: 3

Core Ingredients

- chicken or vegetables
- green curry paste
- coconut milk
- basil

Optional Ingredients

- bell pepper
- fish sauce

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
fish sauce	soy sauce for vegetarian version
chicken	tofu or mixed vegetables

Instructions

74. Saute curry paste in a little oil until fragrant.
75. Add coconut milk, bring to simmer.
76. Add chicken/vegetables, cook until done.
77. Season with fish sauce, garnish with basil.

Cooking Tips

- Use full-fat coconut milk for a richer curry.

R018 · Vegetable Korma

Indian | *vegetarian, gluten-free*

Prep / Cook Time: 15 min prep, 30 min cook

Servings: 4

Core Ingredients

- mixed vegetables
- cashews
- yogurt
- onion
- spices

Optional Ingredients

- cream
- raisins

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
yogurt	coconut milk for vegan
cashews	almonds

Instructions

- Blend cashews and onion into a smooth paste.
- Saute the paste in oil until fragrant.
- Add vegetables and spices, cook 5 minutes.
- Add yogurt/coconut milk, simmer until vegetables are tender.

Cooking Tips

- Blending cashews gives korma its signature creamy texture without heavy cream.

R019 · Sambhar

South Indian | *vegetarian, vegan, gluten-free*

Prep / Cook Time: 15 min prep, 30 min cook

Servings: 4

Core Ingredients

- toor dal
- mixed vegetables
- tamarind
- sambhar powder

Optional Ingredients

- curry leaves
- mustard seeds

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
tamarind	lemon juice as a tangy substitute

Instructions

82. Cook dal until soft.
83. Boil vegetables with tamarind water and sambhar powder.
84. Mix in cooked dal, simmer 10 minutes.
85. Temper mustard seeds and curry leaves, pour over sambhar.

Cooking Tips

- Balancing tamarind's tartness with a little jaggery improves flavor depth.

R020 · Vegan Stir-Fried Noodles

Chinese | *vegan, vegetarian, dairy-free*

Prep / Cook Time: 10 min prep, 15 min cook

Servings: 3

Core Ingredients

- noodles
- mixed vegetables
- garlic
- soy sauce
- oil

Optional Ingredients

- tofu
- sesame seeds

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
noodles	rice noodles for gluten-free
soy sauce	tamari

Instructions

86. Boil noodles, drain, toss with oil.
87. Saute garlic on high heat.
88. Add vegetables, stir-fry 3-4 minutes.
89. Add noodles and soy sauce, toss well.
90. Garnish with sesame and spring onion.

Cooking Tips

- Keep vegetables crunchy for authentic texture.

R021 · Chicken Stir Fry

American/Fusion | *non-vegetarian, gluten-free, dairy-free*

Prep / Cook Time: 10 min prep, 15 min cook

Servings: 3

Core Ingredients

- chicken breast

- mixed vegetables
- garlic
- soy sauce

Optional Ingredients

- ginger
- sesame oil

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
chicken	tofu for vegetarian
soy sauce	tamari

Instructions

91. Slice and season chicken.
92. Sear chicken until golden; set aside.
93. Saute garlic and vegetables until crisp-tender.
94. Return chicken, add soy sauce, toss and cook 2 minutes.

Cooking Tips

- Cook chicken in batches to avoid overcrowding the pan.

R022 · Schezwan Noodles

Indo-Chinese | vegetarian, vegan

Prep / Cook Time: 10 min prep, 15 min cook

Servings: 3

Core Ingredients

- noodles
- schezwan sauce
- garlic
- mixed vegetables

Optional Ingredients

- spring onion
- vinegar

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
schezwan sauce	chili garlic sauce + soy sauce mix

Instructions

95. Boil noodles, drain and set aside.
96. Saute garlic and vegetables on high flame.
97. Add schezwan sauce and noodles, toss well.
98. Garnish with spring onion.

Cooking Tips

- Adjust chili level of sauce to taste before adding.

R023 · Beef and Broccoli Stir Fry

Chinese | *non-vegetarian, dairy-free*

Prep / Cook Time: 15 min prep, 15 min cook

Servings: 3

Core Ingredients

- beef strips
- broccoli
- garlic
- soy sauce
- cornstarch

Optional Ingredients

- ginger
- oyster sauce

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
beef	chicken or mushrooms
oyster sauce	soy sauce + sugar

Instructions

99. Marinate beef with soy sauce and cornstarch.
100. Sear beef quickly on high heat; set aside.
101. Stir-fry broccoli and garlic until bright green.
102. Return beef, add sauce, toss and cook 2 minutes.

Cooking Tips

- Slicing beef thinly against the grain keeps it tender.

R024 · Vegetable Chow Mein

Chinese | *vegetarian, vegan*

Prep / Cook Time: 10 min prep, 15 min cook

Servings: 3

Core Ingredients

- noodles
- cabbage
- carrot
- capsicum
- soy sauce

Optional Ingredients

- spring onion
- vinegar

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
noodles	rice noodles for gluten-free

Instructions

103. Boil noodles, drain and toss with oil.
104. Stir-fry julienned vegetables on high heat.
105. Add noodles and soy sauce, toss thoroughly.
106. Garnish and serve hot.

Cooking Tips

- Julienne vegetables uniformly for even cooking.

R025 · Shrimp Fried Rice

Chinese | *non-vegetarian, dairy-free*

Prep / Cook Time: 10 min prep, 15 min cook

Servings: 3

Core Ingredients

- cooked rice
- shrimp
- eggs
- garlic
- soy sauce

Optional Ingredients

- peas
- spring onion

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
shrimp	chicken or tofu

Instructions

107. Saute shrimp until pink; set aside.
108. Scramble eggs, set aside.
109. Saute garlic and vegetables, add rice and soy sauce.
110. Fold in shrimp and eggs, toss and serve.

Cooking Tips

- Do not overcook shrimp — it turns rubbery quickly.

R026 · Pad Thai

Thai | *non-vegetarian, dairy-free*

Prep / Cook Time: 15 min prep, 20 min cook

Servings: 3

Core Ingredients

- rice noodles

- egg
- tofu or shrimp
- tamarind paste
- bean sprouts

Optional Ingredients

- peanuts
- lime

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
tamarind paste	lime juice + brown sugar mix
shrimp	tofu or chicken

Instructions

111. Soak rice noodles until pliable.
112. Stir-fry protein until cooked; push aside, scramble egg in same pan.
113. Add noodles and tamarind sauce, toss well.
114. Add bean sprouts, toss briefly, garnish with peanuts and lime.

Cooking Tips

- Keep the sauce-to-noodle ratio balanced to avoid sogginess.

R027 • Chickpea Salad

Mediterranean | *vegan, vegetarian, gluten-free, dairy-free*

Prep / Cook Time: 10 min prep, 0 min cook

Servings: 2

Core Ingredients

- chickpeas
- cucumber
- tomato
- onion
- lemon
- olive oil

Optional Ingredients

- feta cheese
- parsley

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
chickpeas	kidney or black beans
feta	omit or tofu crumbles

Instructions

115. Drain and rinse chickpeas.
116. Chop vegetables into small cubes.
117. Combine chickpeas and vegetables in a bowl.
118. Dress with olive oil, lemon, salt and pepper.

119. Chill 10 minutes before serving.

Cooking Tips

- Tastes better after resting 30 minutes for flavors to meld.

R028 · Greek Salad

Mediterranean | vegetarian, gluten-free

Prep / Cook Time: 10 min prep, 0 min cook

Servings: 2

Core Ingredients

- cucumber
- tomato
- red onion
- feta cheese
- olives
- olive oil

Optional Ingredients

- oregano

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
feta	paneer or omit for vegan

Instructions

120. Chop cucumber, tomato, and onion into chunks.
121. Combine with olives and crumbled feta.
122. Dress with olive oil and oregano, toss gently.

Cooking Tips

- Use day-old bread cubes as a crunchy addition (panzanella style).

R029 · Caprese Salad

Italian | vegetarian, gluten-free

Prep / Cook Time: 10 min prep, 0 min cook

Servings: 2

Core Ingredients

- tomato
- mozzarella
- basil
- olive oil

Optional Ingredients

- balsamic glaze

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
mozzarella	any soft cheese
fresh basil	dried basil (small amount)

Instructions

123. Slice tomato and mozzarella into rounds.
124. Arrange alternating on a plate with basil leaves.
125. Drizzle with olive oil and balsamic glaze, season with salt and pepper.

Cooking Tips

- Use ripe, in-season tomatoes for the best flavor.

R030 • Kachumber Salad

Indian | *vegan, vegetarian, gluten-free, dairy-free*

Prep / Cook Time: 10 min prep, 0 min cook

Servings: 2

Core Ingredients

- cucumber
- tomato
- onion
- lemon
- coriander

Optional Ingredients

- green chili
- chaat masala

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
lemon	vinegar

Instructions

126. Finely chop cucumber, tomato, and onion.
127. Combine in a bowl with chopped coriander.
128. Season with lemon juice, salt, and chaat masala.

Cooking Tips

- A refreshing side that pairs with any Indian meal.

R031 • Vegetable Clear Soup

International | *vegan, vegetarian, gluten-free, dairy-free*

Prep / Cook Time: 10 min prep, 15 min cook

Servings: 3

Core Ingredients

- mixed vegetables

- garlic
- vegetable stock
- pepper

Optional Ingredients

- spring onion
- soy sauce

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
vegetable stock	water with bouillon cube

Instructions

129. Chop vegetables finely and uniformly.
130. Boil stock with garlic and vegetables.
131. Simmer 10 minutes until tender.
132. Season with salt, pepper, and soy sauce.

Cooking Tips

- Great way to use up vegetable scraps before they spoil.

R032 · Tomato Soup

International | *vegetarian, gluten-free*

Prep / Cook Time: 10 min prep, 25 min cook

Servings: 3

Core Ingredients

- tomato
- onion
- garlic
- cream

Optional Ingredients

- basil
- butter

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
cream	milk or cashew paste

Instructions

133. Saute onion and garlic until soft.
134. Add chopped tomatoes, cook until mushy.
135. Blend smooth, return to pot.
136. Add cream, simmer, season and serve with basil.

Cooking Tips

- Roasting tomatoes first deepens the flavor.

R033 · Sweet Corn Soup

Chinese | *vegetarian, gluten-free*

Prep / Cook Time: 10 min prep, 15 min cook

Servings: 3

Core Ingredients

- sweet corn
- cornstarch
- vegetable stock
- spring onion

Optional Ingredients

- egg
- garlic

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
cornstarch	omit for thinner soup

Instructions

137. Boil stock with corn.
138. Mix cornstarch with water and stir in to thicken.
139. Drizzle beaten egg in slowly while stirring for egg-drop effect (optional).
140. Garnish with spring onion and serve hot.

Cooking Tips

- Stir continuously while adding cornstarch slurry to avoid lumps.

R034 · Chicken Noodle Soup

American | *non-vegetarian*

Prep / Cook Time: 15 min prep, 30 min cook

Servings: 4

Core Ingredients

- chicken
- noodles
- carrot
- celery
- onion
- stock

Optional Ingredients

- parsley

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
noodles	rice or gluten-free noodles

Instructions

141. Saute onion, carrot, celery until soft.
142. Add stock and chicken, simmer until cooked.
143. Shred chicken, return to pot.
144. Add noodles, cook until tender, garnish with parsley.

Cooking Tips

- A classic comfort food, great for using leftover roast chicken.

R035 · Vegetable Sandwich

International | *vegetarian, vegan option*

Prep / Cook Time: 10 min prep, 5 min cook

Servings: 2

Core Ingredients

- bread
- cucumber
- tomato
- onion
- butter

Optional Ingredients

- cheese
- chutney

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
butter	vegan spread
cheese	omit for vegan

Instructions

145. Spread butter/chutney on bread slices.
146. Layer sliced vegetables evenly.
147. Top with second slice, grill or toast if desired.
148. Cut and serve.

Cooking Tips

- Grilling adds crunch, but it's equally good cold for a quick lunch.

R036 · Paneer Tikka Wrap

Indian | *vegetarian, gluten-free (use GF wrap)*

Prep / Cook Time: 15 min prep, 15 min cook

Servings: 2

Core Ingredients

- paneer
- yogurt

- spices
- tortilla/roti
- onion

Optional Ingredients

- mint chutney
- capsicum

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
paneer	tofu or chicken
tortilla	roti or lettuce wrap

Instructions

149. Marinate paneer cubes in yogurt and spices.
150. Grill or pan-fry until charred.
151. Warm tortilla/roti, spread chutney.
152. Add paneer, onion, and vegetables, roll tightly.

Cooking Tips

- A hot tawa/pan sear gives authentic charred tikka flavor.

R037 • Bean Quesadilla

Mexican | *vegetarian, gluten-free (corn tortilla)*

Prep / Cook Time: 10 min prep, 10 min cook

Servings: 2

Core Ingredients

- tortilla
- beans
- cheese
- onion

Optional Ingredients

- capsicum
- salsa

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
tortilla	corn tortilla or chapati
cheese	vegan cheese or omit

Instructions

153. Mash beans, season with spices.
154. Spread on tortilla with cheese, fold.
155. Cook on a hot pan until golden and crisp both sides.
156. Cut into wedges, serve with salsa.

Cooking Tips

- Press gently with a spatula for even crisping.

R038 · Egg Sandwich

International | *non-vegetarian*

Prep / Cook Time: 10 min prep, 10 min cook

Servings: 2

Core Ingredients

- bread
- boiled eggs
- mayonnaise
- onion

Optional Ingredients

- lettuce
- black pepper

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
mayonnaise	mustard or butter

Instructions

157. Mash boiled eggs with mayonnaise and seasoning.
158. Spread on bread slices.
159. Add lettuce and onion if using, close sandwich, cut and serve.

Cooking Tips

- Chilling the egg mixture briefly makes it easier to spread.

R039 · Aloo Paratha

Indian | *vegetarian, dairy-free option*

Prep / Cook Time: 20 min prep, 25 min cook

Servings: 3

Core Ingredients

- whole wheat flour
- potato
- spices
- ghee

Optional Ingredients

- coriander
- onion

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
ghee	oil for vegan

Instructions

160. Boil and mash potatoes with spices.
161. Stuff dough balls with potato filling, roll gently.
162. Cook on a hot tawa with ghee/oil until golden on both sides.

Cooking Tips

- Keep filling well-sealed inside the dough to prevent tearing while rolling.

R040 · Vegetable Cutlet

Indian | *vegetarian, vegan*

Prep / Cook Time: 15 min prep, 20 min cook

Servings: 3

Core Ingredients

- boiled potato
- mixed vegetables
- breadcrumbs
- spices

Optional Ingredients

- green chili
- coriander

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
breadcrumbs	crushed poha or oats

Instructions

163. Mash boiled potato and mixed vegetables together.
164. Add spices and shape into patties.
165. Coat with breadcrumbs, shallow fry until golden on both sides.

Cooking Tips

- Chilling patties for 10 minutes before frying helps them hold shape.

R041 · Hummus with Veggie Sticks

Mediterranean | *vegan, vegetarian, gluten-free, dairy-free*

Prep / Cook Time: 10 min prep, 0 min cook

Servings: 3

Core Ingredients

- chickpeas
- tahini
- garlic
- lemon
- olive oil

Optional Ingredients

- cucumber sticks
- carrot sticks

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
tahini	peanut butter (different flavor, works in a pinch)

Instructions

166. Blend chickpeas, tahini, garlic, lemon, and olive oil until smooth.
167. Adjust consistency with water if needed.
168. Serve with fresh vegetable sticks.

Cooking Tips

- Peeling chickpeas before blending gives a silkier hummus.

R042 · Besan Chilla

Indian | *vegan, vegetarian, gluten-free*

Prep / Cook Time: 10 min prep, 15 min cook

Servings: 2

Core Ingredients

- besan
- onion
- tomato
- spices
- water

Optional Ingredients

- coriander
- green chili

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
besan	no direct substitute

Instructions

169. Mix besan with water into a smooth batter.
170. Add chopped vegetables and spices.
171. Pour on a hot pan, spread thin, cook both sides with a little oil.

Cooking Tips

- Batter consistency should resemble regular pancake batter.

R043 · Plain Dosa

South Indian | *vegan, vegetarian, gluten-free*

Prep / Cook Time: 10 min prep, 15 min cook

Servings: 3

Core Ingredients

- dosa batter (rice and urad dal)
- oil

Optional Ingredients

- potato masala
- chutney

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
dosa batter	can substitute with rava/oats batter in a pinch

Instructions

172. Heat a flat pan, pour a ladle of batter and spread thin in circular motion.
173. Drizzle oil around edges, cook until golden and crisp.
174. Fold and serve with chutney or sambhar.

Cooking Tips

- A well-seasoned pan is key to dosas not sticking.

R044 · Oats Vegetable Upma

Indian | *vegetarian, vegan option*

Prep / Cook Time: 5 min prep, 15 min cook

Servings: 2

Core Ingredients

- oats
- mixed vegetables
- onion
- mustard seeds
- curry leaves

Optional Ingredients

- peanuts
- ghee

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
oats	semolina (rava)
ghee	oil

Instructions

175. Dry roast oats, set aside.
176. Temper mustard seeds and curry leaves in oil.
177. Saute onion and vegetables until soft.
178. Add water, bring to boil, stir in oats, cook until thickened.

Cooking Tips

- Roasting oats first prevents mushiness.

R045 · Peanut Butter Banana Oats

International | vegetarian, vegan option, gluten-free (certified oats)**Prep / Cook Time:** 5 min prep, 0 min cook**Servings:** 1**Core Ingredients**

- oats
- banana
- peanut butter
- milk

Optional Ingredients

- honey
- chia seeds

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
milk	plant-based milk
peanut butter	almond butter

Instructions

179. Mash banana in a bowl.
180. Add oats and milk, mix well.
181. Stir in peanut butter.
182. Let sit 5 minutes or refrigerate overnight, top and serve.

Cooking Tips

- Great make-ahead breakfast prepared the night before.

R046 · Vegetable Poha

Indian | vegan, vegetarian, gluten-free**Prep / Cook Time:** 10 min prep, 15 min cook**Servings:** 2**Core Ingredients**

- flattened rice (poha)
- onion
- potato
- mustard seeds
- curry leaves
- peanuts

Optional Ingredients

- lemon

- coriander

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
peanuts	cashews or omit

Instructions

183. Rinse poha in a strainer until soft; set aside.
184. Temper mustard seeds, curry leaves, and peanuts in oil.
185. Saute onion and potato until cooked.
186. Add poha, turmeric, and salt, mix gently.
187. Finish with lemon juice and coriander.

Cooking Tips

- Rinse poha briefly — soaking too long makes it mushy.

R047 · Pancakes (Basic)

American | *vegetarian*

Prep / Cook Time: 10 min prep, 15 min cook

Servings: 3

Core Ingredients

- flour
- milk
- egg
- sugar
- baking powder

Optional Ingredients

- butter
- maple syrup

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
milk	plant-based milk
egg	mashed banana or flax egg

Instructions

188. Whisk dry ingredients together.
189. Whisk in milk and egg until just combined (small lumps are fine).
190. Pour batter onto a hot greased pan, cook until bubbles form, flip and cook other side.
191. Serve with butter and syrup.

Cooking Tips

- Do not overmix batter — this keeps pancakes fluffy.

R048 · Vegetable Omelette

International | *non-vegetarian, gluten-free*

Prep / Cook Time: 5 min prep, 10 min cook

Servings: 1

Core Ingredients

- eggs
- onion
- tomato
- capsicum

Optional Ingredients

- cheese
- herbs

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
capsicum	any available vegetable

Instructions

192. Whisk eggs with salt and pepper.
193. Saute chopped vegetables briefly in a pan.
194. Pour eggs over vegetables, cook until set, fold and serve.

Cooking Tips

- Cook on medium-low heat for a tender omelette.

R049 · Egg Bhurji

Indian | *non-vegetarian, gluten-free, dairy-free*

Prep / Cook Time: 5 min prep, 10 min cook

Servings: 2

Core Ingredients

- eggs
- onion
- tomato
- green chili
- spices

Optional Ingredients

- capsicum
- coriander

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
green chili	red chili powder

Instructions

195. Saute onion until translucent.
196. Add tomato and chili, cook until soft.
197. Add spices, crack in eggs, scramble continuously until just set.
198. Garnish with coriander.

Cooking Tips

- Keep flame medium-low to avoid rubbery eggs.

R050 · Classic Margherita Pasta

Italian | *vegetarian*

Prep / Cook Time: 10 min prep, 20 min cook

Servings: 2

Core Ingredients

- pasta
- tomato
- garlic
- olive oil
- basil

Optional Ingredients

- parmesan
- chili flakes

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
parmesan	nutritional yeast for vegan
pasta	gluten-free pasta

Instructions

199. Boil pasta, reserve some pasta water.
200. Saute garlic in olive oil.
201. Add tomatoes, simmer until thick.
202. Toss pasta into sauce, adding pasta water as needed.
203. Garnish with basil and cheese.

Cooking Tips

- Reserved starchy water helps sauce cling to pasta.

R051 · Creamy Alfredo Pasta

Italian | *vegetarian*

Prep / Cook Time: 10 min prep, 20 min cook

Servings: 2

Core Ingredients

- pasta
- butter

- cream
- garlic
- parmesan

Optional Ingredients

- black pepper
- parsley

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
cream	milk + cornstarch slurry
parmesan	any hard cheese

Instructions

204. Boil pasta until al dente.
205. Saute garlic in butter.
206. Add cream, simmer gently, whisk in cheese.
207. Toss pasta in sauce, season with pepper, garnish with parsley.

Cooking Tips

- Keep heat low when adding cheese to prevent the sauce from splitting.

R052 · Vegetable Stir Fry Pasta

Fusion | *vegetarian, vegan option*

Prep / Cook Time: 10 min prep, 20 min cook

Servings: 2

Core Ingredients

- pasta
- mixed vegetables
- garlic
- olive oil
- soy sauce

Optional Ingredients

- chili flakes

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
soy sauce	tamari

Instructions

208. Boil pasta, drain and toss with oil.
209. Stir-fry vegetables and garlic on high heat.
210. Add pasta and soy sauce, toss to combine.
211. Season and serve.

Cooking Tips

- A great fusion way to use leftover pasta and vegetable odds and ends.

R053 · Mushroom Risotto

Italian | *vegetarian, gluten-free*

Prep / Cook Time: 10 min prep, 35 min cook

Servings: 3

Core Ingredients

- arborio rice
- mushroom
- onion
- vegetable stock
- butter
- parmesan

Optional Ingredients

- white wine
- thyme

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
butter	olive oil for dairy-free
parmesan	nutritional yeast

Instructions

212. Saute onion and mushrooms until soft.
213. Add rice, toast briefly.
214. Add stock gradually, stirring continuously until absorbed each time.
215. Once rice is creamy and cooked, stir in butter and parmesan.

Cooking Tips

- Add stock a ladle at a time and stir often for the classic creamy texture.

R054 · Baked Vegetable Pasta

Italian/Fusion | *vegetarian*

Prep / Cook Time: 15 min prep, 30 min cook

Servings: 4

Core Ingredients

- pasta
- mixed vegetables
- tomato sauce
- cheese

Optional Ingredients

- oregano
- garlic

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
cheese	vegan cheese

Instructions

- 216. Boil pasta until al dente.
- 217. Mix with tomato sauce and sauteed vegetables.
- 218. Transfer to a baking dish, top with cheese.
- 219. Bake until cheese melts and bubbles.

Cooking Tips

- Broiling for the last 2 minutes gives a nice golden top.

R055 • Garlic Bread

Italian | *vegetarian***Prep / Cook Time:** 5 min prep, 10 min cook**Servings:** 3**Core Ingredients**

- bread
- butter
- garlic
- parsley

Optional Ingredients

- cheese
- chili flakes

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
butter	olive oil for dairy-free

Instructions

- 220. Mix softened butter with minced garlic and parsley.
- 221. Spread generously on bread slices.
- 222. Toast/bake until golden and crisp.

Cooking Tips

- Broil for the last minute for extra crispiness — watch closely to avoid burning.

R056 • Grilled Chicken Breast

International | *non-vegetarian, gluten-free, dairy-free***Prep / Cook Time:** 15 min prep, 20 min cook**Servings:** 2**Core Ingredients**

- chicken breast
- olive oil
- garlic

- herbs

Optional Ingredients

- lemon
- black pepper

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
chicken breast	chicken thigh for juicier result

Instructions

223. Marinate chicken with oil, garlic, herbs, salt and pepper.
224. Rest 15 minutes.
225. Grill or pan-sear on medium-high heat, 6-7 minutes per side until cooked through.
226. Rest 5 minutes before slicing.

Cooking Tips

- Resting the meat after cooking keeps it juicy.

R057 • Fish Curry

Indian (Coastal) | non-vegetarian, gluten-free, dairy-free

Prep / Cook Time: 15 min prep, 25 min cook

Servings: 3

Core Ingredients

- fish fillets
- coconut milk
- tamarind
- spices
- onion

Optional Ingredients

- curry leaves
- green chili

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
coconut milk	cream
tamarind	lemon juice

Instructions

227. Saute onion and spices until fragrant.
228. Add coconut milk and tamarind water, simmer.
229. Add fish fillets, cook gently until just done (do not overcook).
230. Garnish and serve.

Cooking Tips

- Add fish last and simmer gently to avoid it breaking apart.

R058 · Chicken Tikka

Indian | *non-vegetarian, gluten-free*

Prep / Cook Time: 20 min prep, 20 min cook

Servings: 3

Core Ingredients

- chicken
- yogurt
- spices
- lemon

Optional Ingredients

- onion
- capsicum for skewers

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
yogurt	dairy-free yogurt

Instructions

231. Marinate chicken in yogurt, spices, and lemon for at least 30 minutes.
232. Thread onto skewers with vegetables if desired.
233. Grill or bake until charred and cooked through.

Cooking Tips

- Marinating longer (a few hours) deepens the flavor significantly.

R059 · Mutton Curry

Indian | *non-vegetarian, gluten-free, dairy-free*

Prep / Cook Time: 20 min prep, 60 min cook

Servings: 4

Core Ingredients

- mutton
- onion
- tomato
- garlic
- ginger
- spices

Optional Ingredients

- yogurt
- coriander

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
mutton	chicken (reduce cooking time significantly)

Instructions

- 234. Marinate mutton with yogurt and spices.
- 235. Saute onion, garlic, ginger until deep golden.
- 236. Add mutton, sear, then add tomato and spices.
- 237. Add water, pressure cook until tender.
- 238. Garnish with coriander.

Cooking Tips

- Slow cooking or pressure cooking is essential for tender mutton.

R060 • Shrimp Scampi

Italian/American | *non-vegetarian***Prep / Cook Time:** 10 min prep, 15 min cook**Servings:** 2**Core Ingredients**

- shrimp
- garlic
- butter
- white wine
- pasta

Optional Ingredients

- chili flakes
- parsley

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
white wine	chicken stock + lemon juice

Instructions

- 239. Boil pasta if serving with it.
- 240. Saute garlic in butter until fragrant.
- 241. Add shrimp, cook until pink.
- 242. Add wine, simmer briefly, toss with pasta and garnish.

Cooking Tips

- Do not overcook shrimp — remove from heat as soon as they turn pink and curl.

R061 • Roast Chicken

International | *non-vegetarian, gluten-free, dairy-free***Prep / Cook Time:** 20 min prep, 60 min cook**Servings:** 4**Core Ingredients**

- whole chicken

- butter/oil
- garlic
- herbs
- lemon

Optional Ingredients

- potatoes
- carrots

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
butter	oil for dairy-free

Instructions

243. Rub chicken with butter/oil, garlic, herbs, salt and pepper, inside and out.
244. Stuff cavity with lemon and herbs.
245. Roast in oven until internal temperature reaches safe doneness, basting occasionally.
246. Rest 10 minutes before carving.

Cooking Tips

- Resting after roasting redistributes juices for a moister result.

R062 • Masala Papad

Indian | *vegan, vegetarian, gluten-free*

Prep / Cook Time: 5 min prep, 5 min cook

Servings: 2

Core Ingredients

- papad
- onion
- tomato
- chaat masala

Optional Ingredients

- coriander
- green chili

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
papad	any lentil/rice cracker

Instructions

247. Roast or fry papad until crisp.
248. Top with finely chopped onion, tomato, and chaat masala.
249. Serve immediately.

Cooking Tips

- Serve immediately after topping to keep the papad crisp.

R063 · Fruit Chaat

Indian | *vegan, vegetarian, gluten-free, dairy-free*

Prep / Cook Time: 10 min prep, 0 min cook

Servings: 2

Core Ingredients

- seasonal fruits
- chaat masala
- lemon

Optional Ingredients

- mint leaves

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
chaat masala	black salt + pepper mix

Instructions

250. Chop assorted fruits into bite-size pieces.
251. Toss with chaat masala and lemon juice.
252. Garnish with mint and serve chilled.

Cooking Tips

- A great way to use up ripening fruits before they spoil.

R064 · Roasted Chickpeas

International | *vegan, vegetarian, gluten-free, dairy-free*

Prep / Cook Time: 5 min prep, 25 min cook

Servings: 3

Core Ingredients

- chickpeas
- olive oil
- spices

Optional Ingredients

- chili powder
- garlic powder

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
chickpeas	canned or boiled dried chickpeas

Instructions

253. Pat chickpeas completely dry.
254. Toss with oil and spices.
255. Roast in oven or air fryer until crisp, shaking occasionally.

Cooking Tips

- Drying chickpeas thoroughly before roasting is key to crispiness.

R065 · Banana Oat Cookies

International | vegetarian, vegan, gluten-free (certified oats)

Prep / Cook Time: 10 min prep, 15 min cook

Servings: 3

Core Ingredients

- banana
- oats
- cinnamon

Optional Ingredients

- chocolate chips
- nuts

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
banana	applesauce

Instructions

256. Mash banana thoroughly.
257. Mix with oats and cinnamon (and mix-ins if using).
258. Shape into small rounds on a baking tray.
259. Bake until lightly golden and set.

Cooking Tips

- A 2-ingredient base (banana + oats) makes this a flexible, forgiving recipe for using overripe bananas.

R066 · Vegetable Pakora

Indian | vegan, vegetarian, gluten-free

Prep / Cook Time: 15 min prep, 20 min cook

Servings: 3

Core Ingredients

- besan
- mixed vegetables
- spices

Optional Ingredients

- rice flour for crispiness

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
besan	no direct substitute

Instructions

- 260. Make a thick batter with besan, water, and spices.
- 261. Dip sliced vegetables into batter.
- 262. Deep fry until golden and crisp.
- 263. Serve hot with chutney.

Cooking Tips

- Adding a spoon of hot oil to the batter makes pakoras extra crispy.

R067 · Rice Pudding (Kheer)

Indian | *vegetarian, gluten-free*

Prep / Cook Time: 10 min prep, 40 min cook

Servings: 4

Core Ingredients

- rice
- milk
- sugar
- cardamom

Optional Ingredients

- nuts
- saffron

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
milk	any plant-based milk for vegan

Instructions

- 264. Cook rice in milk on low heat, stirring occasionally, until thick and creamy.
- 265. Add sugar and cardamom, simmer 10 more minutes.
- 266. Garnish with nuts and saffron, serve warm or chilled.

Cooking Tips

- Low and slow cooking is essential — do not rush this dish.

R068 · Chocolate Banana Smoothie

International | *vegetarian, vegan option, gluten-free*

Prep / Cook Time: 5 min prep, 0 min cook

Servings: 1

Core Ingredients

- banana
- milk
- cocoa powder

Optional Ingredients

- honey

- peanut butter

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
milk	plant-based milk

Instructions

267. Add all ingredients to a blender.
268. Blend until smooth.
269. Pour and serve chilled.

Cooking Tips

- Freeze banana slices in advance for a thicker, colder smoothie.

R069 • Vegetable Momos

Tibetan/Indian | vegetarian, vegan

Prep / Cook Time: 30 min prep, 20 min cook

Servings: 4

Core Ingredients

- flour
- mixed vegetables (finely chopped)
- garlic
- ginger

Optional Ingredients

- soy sauce
- spring onion

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
flour	whole wheat flour

Instructions

270. Make a stiff dough with flour and water; rest 20 minutes.
271. Saute finely chopped vegetables with garlic and ginger.
272. Roll dough into small circles, fill and pleat into dumplings.
273. Steam for 15-18 minutes until translucent.

Cooking Tips

- Chop the filling very finely so it cooks through during the short steaming time.

R070 • Vegetable Spring Rolls

Chinese | vegetarian, vegan

Prep / Cook Time: 15 min prep, 15 min cook

Servings: 4

Core Ingredients

- spring roll wrappers
- cabbage
- carrot
- garlic

Optional Ingredients

- soy sauce
- bean sprouts

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
spring roll wrappers	can substitute with thin crepe if unavailable

Instructions

274. Stir-fry julienned vegetables with garlic and soy sauce until just tender; cool.
275. Place filling on wrappers, roll tightly, sealing edges with water.
276. Deep fry or bake until golden and crisp.

Cooking Tips

- Let the filling cool completely before wrapping to prevent soggy wrappers.

R071 · Stuffed Bell Peppers

American/Fusion | *vegetarian option, gluten-free*

Prep / Cook Time: 20 min prep, 35 min cook

Servings: 4

Core Ingredients

- bell peppers
- rice
- mixed vegetables or ground meat
- cheese

Optional Ingredients

- tomato sauce
- herbs

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
ground meat	cooked lentils or crumbled paneer for vegetarian

Instructions

277. Halve peppers and remove seeds.
278. Mix cooked rice with vegetables/meat and seasoning.
279. Stuff peppers with mixture, top with cheese.
280. Bake until peppers are tender and cheese is golden.

Cooking Tips

- Par-boiling peppers briefly beforehand ensures they cook evenly in the oven.

R072 · Vegetable Frittata

Italian | *vegetarian, gluten-free*

Prep / Cook Time: 10 min prep, 25 min cook

Servings: 3

Core Ingredients

- eggs
- mixed vegetables
- cheese
- onion

Optional Ingredients

- herbs

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
cheese	omit or use dairy-free cheese

Instructions

281. Sauté onion and vegetables in an oven-safe pan.
282. Whisk eggs with salt and pepper, pour over vegetables.
283. Cook on stovetop until edges set, then transfer to oven to finish cooking through.
284. Top with cheese before the last few minutes of baking.

Cooking Tips

- A great way to use up small amounts of many different vegetables.

R073 · Baingan Bharta

Indian | *vegan, vegetarian, gluten-free*

Prep / Cook Time: 10 min prep, 30 min cook

Servings: 3

Core Ingredients

- eggplant
- onion
- tomato
- garlic
- spices

Optional Ingredients

- coriander
- green chili

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
eggplant	no direct substitute; essential to this dish

Instructions

- 285. Roast eggplant directly over flame or in oven until charred and soft.
- 286. Peel and mash the flesh.
- 287. Saute onion, garlic, tomato and spices until cooked down.
- 288. Add mashed eggplant, mix well and simmer 5 minutes.

Cooking Tips

- Charring the eggplant directly over a flame gives the dish its signature smoky flavor.

R074 · Aloo Gobi

Indian | *vegan, vegetarian, gluten-free, dairy-free*

Prep / Cook Time: 15 min prep, 25 min cook

Servings: 3

Core Ingredients

- potato
- cauliflower
- onion
- tomato
- spices

Optional Ingredients

- coriander
- ginger

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
cauliflower	broccoli in a pinch

Instructions

- 289. Saute onion and spices until fragrant.
- 290. Add potato and cauliflower, mix well.
- 291. Add tomato, cover and cook on low heat until vegetables are tender, stirring occasionally.
- 292. Garnish with coriander.

Cooking Tips

- Cooking covered on low heat allows the vegetables to steam-cook without needing much oil.

R075 · Bhindi Fry

Indian | *vegan, vegetarian, gluten-free, dairy-free*

Prep / Cook Time: 10 min prep, 20 min cook

Servings: 3

Core Ingredients

- okra
- onion
- spices

Optional Ingredients

- lemon
- garlic

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
okra	no direct substitute

Instructions

293. Wash and dry okra thoroughly, slice.
294. Saute onion until golden.
295. Add okra and spices, cook uncovered on medium heat, stirring occasionally until non-slimy and lightly crisp.

Cooking Tips

- Drying okra completely before cooking and cooking uncovered reduces sliminess.

R076 · Vegetable Kofta Curry

Indian | *vegetarian, gluten-free***Prep / Cook Time:** 20 min prep, 30 min cook**Servings:** 4**Core Ingredients**

- mixed grated vegetables
- besan
- onion
- tomato
- cream

Optional Ingredients

- cashews
- spices

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
cream	cashew paste or milk

Instructions

296. Mix grated vegetables with besan and spices, shape into balls, deep fry until golden.
297. Prepare an onion-tomato gravy base, simmer until thick.
298. Add cream, simmer briefly.
299. Add fried koftas just before serving to keep them from getting soggy.

Cooking Tips

- Add koftas right before serving so they don't turn mushy in the gravy.

R077 · Masala Dosa

South Indian | *vegetarian, vegan option, gluten-free*

Prep / Cook Time: 15 min prep, 20 min cook

Servings: 3

Core Ingredients

- dosa batter
- potato
- onion
- mustard seeds
- curry leaves

Optional Ingredients

- chutney
- sambhar

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
dosa batter	rava/oats batter substitute

Instructions

300. Prepare potato masala: temper mustard seeds and curry leaves, saute onion, add boiled mashed potato and turmeric.
301. Spread dosa batter thin on a hot pan, cook until crisp.
302. Place potato masala in the center, fold and serve with chutney and sambhar.

Cooking Tips

- Keep the potato masala slightly warm before filling for the best texture contrast.

R078 · Vegetable Manchurian

Indo-Chinese | *vegetarian, vegan*

Prep / Cook Time: 15 min prep, 25 min cook

Servings: 3

Core Ingredients

- mixed vegetables
- cornflour
- garlic
- soy sauce

Optional Ingredients

- spring onion
- vinegar

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
cornflour	rice flour

Instructions

303. Mix grated vegetables with cornflour and spices, shape into balls, deep fry until golden.
304. Prepare a garlic-soy sauce gravy, thickened lightly with cornflour slurry.
305. Add fried vegetable balls to the gravy just before serving, toss and garnish.

Cooking Tips

- For 'dry' Manchurian, skip the gravy and toss balls directly in the sauce.

R079 · Sabudana Khichdi

Indian | *vegetarian, vegan option, gluten-free*

Prep / Cook Time: 15 min prep, 15 min cook

Servings: 2

Core Ingredients

- soaked sago (sabudana)
- potato
- peanuts
- cumin seeds

Optional Ingredients

- green chili
- lemon
- coriander

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
peanuts	cashews

Instructions

306. Soak sabudana overnight or for several hours until soft.
307. Heat oil, temper cumin seeds.
308. Add potato and peanuts, saute until potato is cooked.
309. Add soaked sabudana, salt, and toss gently until translucent.
310. Finish with lemon juice and coriander.

Cooking Tips

- Do not over-soak sabudana or it turns mushy and sticky.

R080 · Vegetable Hakka Noodles

Indo-Chinese | *vegetarian, vegan*

Prep / Cook Time: 10 min prep, 15 min cook

Servings: 3

Core Ingredients

- noodles
- cabbage
- carrot
- capsicum
- soy sauce
- garlic

Optional Ingredients

- spring onion
- vinegar

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
noodles	rice noodles for gluten-free

Instructions

311. Boil noodles al dente, drain and toss with a little oil to prevent sticking.
312. Stir-fry garlic and julienned vegetables on high heat.
313. Add noodles, soy sauce, and vinegar, toss thoroughly on high flame.
314. Garnish with spring onion.

Cooking Tips

- Tossing on high heat in a wide pan gives the smoky 'wok hei' flavor.

R081 · Methi Thepla

Indian | *vegan, vegetarian*

Prep / Cook Time: 15 min prep, 20 min cook

Servings: 4

Core Ingredients

- whole wheat flour
- fenugreek leaves
- spices
- oil

Optional Ingredients

- yogurt for dough

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
fenugreek leaves	spinach in a pinch (different flavor)

Instructions

315. Knead flour with chopped fenugreek leaves, spices, and a little oil into a soft dough.
316. Roll into thin rounds.
317. Cook on a hot tawa with a little oil until golden spots appear on both sides.

Cooking Tips

- Theplas stay fresh for days, making them great for travel or meal prep.

R082 · Vegetable Uttapam

South Indian | *vegetarian, vegan, gluten-free*

Prep / Cook Time: 10 min prep, 15 min cook

Servings: 3

Core Ingredients

- dosa batter
- onion
- tomato
- capsicum

Optional Ingredients

- coriander
- green chili

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
dosa batter	rava/oats batter

Instructions

318. Spread dosa batter thick on a hot pan (thicker than regular dosa).
319. Sprinkle chopped vegetables on top while batter is still wet.
320. Cook on low-medium heat until golden, flip and cook the other side briefly.

Cooking Tips

- Cooking on low heat ensures the thick batter cooks through without burning.

R083 · Rasam

South Indian | *vegan, vegetarian, gluten-free, dairy-free*

Prep / Cook Time: 10 min prep, 20 min cook

Servings: 3

Core Ingredients

- tomato
- tamarind
- rasam powder
- garlic

Optional Ingredients

- curry leaves
- coriander

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
tamarind	lemon juice

Instructions

321. Boil tomato, tamarind water, and rasam powder together.
322. Simmer until flavors combine, about 10 minutes.
323. Temper mustard seeds, garlic, and curry leaves in oil, pour over rasam.
324. Garnish with coriander.

Cooking Tips

- Do not over-boil after adding tamarind, as it can turn bitter.

R084 · Vegetable Idli

South Indian | *vegan, vegetarian, gluten-free*

Prep / Cook Time: 10 min prep, 20 min cook

Servings: 4

Core Ingredients

- idli batter
- grated carrot
- peas

Optional Ingredients

- mustard seeds
- curry leaves

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
idli batter	rava idli batter substitute

Instructions

325. Mix grated vegetables into idli batter.
326. Pour into greased idli molds.
327. Steam for 10-12 minutes until a toothpick comes out clean.
328. Serve with chutney or sambhar.

Cooking Tips

- Do not overfill molds — batter rises slightly during steaming.

R085 · Paneer Bhurji

Indian | *vegetarian, gluten-free*

Prep / Cook Time: 10 min prep, 15 min cook

Servings: 2

Core Ingredients

- paneer
- onion
- tomato
- spices

Optional Ingredients

- capsicum
- coriander

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
paneer	tofu, crumbled

Instructions

329. Saute onion until translucent.

- 330. Add tomato and spices, cook until soft.
- 331. Crumble in paneer, mix well and cook 3-4 minutes.
- 332. Garnish with coriander.

Cooking Tips

- Crumbling paneer by hand gives better texture than grating.

R086 · Vegetable Semiya Upma

South Indian | *vegetarian, vegan option*

Prep / Cook Time: 10 min prep, 15 min cook

Servings: 2

Core Ingredients

- vermicelli
- mixed vegetables
- mustard seeds
- curry leaves

Optional Ingredients

- peanuts
- lemon

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
vermicelli	broken wheat noodles

Instructions

- 333. Roast vermicelli lightly until golden; set aside.
- 334. Temper mustard seeds, curry leaves, peanuts in oil.
- 335. Saute vegetables until slightly soft.
- 336. Add water, bring to boil, add roasted vermicelli, cook covered until soft.

Cooking Tips

- Roasting vermicelli first prevents it from turning mushy.

R087 · Chilli Paneer

Indo-Chinese | *vegetarian*

Prep / Cook Time: 15 min prep, 20 min cook

Servings: 3

Core Ingredients

- paneer
- capsicum
- onion
- soy sauce
- garlic
- cornflour

Optional Ingredients

- spring onion
- vinegar

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
paneer	tofu or chicken
cornflour	rice flour

Instructions

337. Coat paneer cubes in cornflour, shallow fry until golden; set aside.
338. Stir-fry garlic, onion, and capsicum on high heat.
339. Add soy sauce and a little cornflour slurry, toss with fried paneer.
340. Garnish with spring onion.

Cooking Tips

- For 'dry' chilli paneer, skip the slurry and toss directly in sauce.

R088 • Vegetable Dhokla

Indian | *vegetarian, vegan option, gluten-free*

Prep / Cook Time: 15 min prep, 20 min cook

Servings: 4

Core Ingredients

- besan
- yogurt
- mixed grated vegetables
- mustard seeds

Optional Ingredients

- curry leaves
- green chili

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
yogurt	lemon juice + water for vegan

Instructions

341. Mix besan, yogurt, grated vegetables, and a leavening agent into a batter.
342. Pour into a greased plate/tin, steam for 15-18 minutes until a toothpick comes out clean.
343. Temper mustard seeds and curry leaves, pour over cooled dhokla, cut into squares.

Cooking Tips

- Steam on medium heat — too high can make the dhokla uneven or rubbery.

R089 • Vegetable Kathi Roll

Indian | *vegetarian, vegan option*

Prep / Cook Time: 15 min prep, 15 min cook

Servings: 2

Core Ingredients

- paratha/flatbread
- mixed vegetables
- onion
- spices

Optional Ingredients

- chutney
- egg

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
paratha	tortilla

Instructions

344. Stir-fry vegetables with onion and spices until cooked.
345. Warm flatbread, spread chutney.
346. Add filling, roll tightly and optionally toast the roll briefly on a pan.

Cooking Tips

- Toasting the rolled wrap briefly on a hot pan seals it and adds crunch.

R090 · Vegetable Pancakes (Savory)

Fusion | vegetarian, vegan option

Prep / Cook Time: 10 min prep, 15 min cook

Servings: 3

Core Ingredients

- grated vegetables
- flour
- spices

Optional Ingredients

- cheese
- herbs

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
flour	chickpea flour for gluten-free

Instructions

347. Mix grated vegetables with flour, spices, and a little water into a thick batter.
348. Pour spoonfuls onto a hot greased pan, flatten slightly.
349. Cook until golden on both sides.

Cooking Tips

- Squeeze excess water from grated vegetables first to keep pancakes from turning soggy.

R091 · Vegetable Fried Rice (Basic)

Chinese | *vegan, vegetarian, gluten-free (with tamari)*

Prep / Cook Time: 10 min prep, 15 min cook

Servings: 3

Core Ingredients

- cooked rice
- mixed vegetables
- garlic
- soy sauce

Optional Ingredients

- spring onion
- sesame oil

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
soy sauce	tamari

Instructions

350. Saute garlic and finely chopped vegetables on high heat.
351. Add cold cooked rice and soy sauce, toss thoroughly.
352. Garnish with spring onion and serve.

Cooking Tips

- Using cold, day-old rice prevents clumping and gives better fried-rice texture.

R092 · Vegetable Biryani (Quick Version)

Indian | *vegetarian, gluten-free*

Prep / Cook Time: 15 min prep, 30 min cook

Servings: 4

Core Ingredients

- rice
- mixed vegetables
- yogurt
- biryani masala

Optional Ingredients

- mint
- fried onion

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
yogurt	coconut milk

Instructions

- 353. Sauté vegetables with biryani masala and yogurt until partially cooked.
- 354. Layer with par-cooked rice in a pot.
- 355. Cover tightly and cook on low heat for 15-20 minutes (dum style).
- 356. Garnish with mint and fried onion before serving.

Cooking Tips

- A quicker one-pot version of traditional dum biryani for weeknight cooking.

R093 · Stuffed Paratha (Mixed Vegetable)

Indian | *vegetarian*

Prep / Cook Time: 20 min prep, 25 min cook

Servings: 3

Core Ingredients

- whole wheat flour
- grated mixed vegetables
- spices
- ghee

Optional Ingredients

- coriander

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
ghee	oil

Instructions

- 357. Squeeze excess water from grated vegetables, mix with spices for filling.
- 358. Stuff dough balls with filling, roll gently into flatbread.
- 359. Cook on a hot tawa with ghee/oil until golden on both sides.

Cooking Tips

- Squeezing moisture from the filling prevents the paratha from tearing while rolling.

R094 · Vegetable Ramen (Quick)

Japanese/Fusion | *vegetarian, vegan option*

Prep / Cook Time: 10 min prep, 20 min cook

Servings: 2

Core Ingredients

- ramen noodles
- mixed vegetables
- garlic
- soy sauce
- vegetable stock

Optional Ingredients

- boiled egg
- spring onion

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
ramen noodles	any instant or fresh noodles
soy sauce	tamari

Instructions

360. Boil stock with garlic and soy sauce.
361. Cook noodles separately as per package instructions.
362. Blanch or stir-fry vegetables briefly.
363. Assemble noodles in broth, top with vegetables and egg if using.

Cooking Tips

- A soft-boiled egg with a jammy yolk is the classic ramen topping.

R095 · Vegetable Korma Rice Bowl

Fusion | *vegetarian, gluten-free*

Prep / Cook Time: 15 min prep, 25 min cook

Servings: 3

Core Ingredients

- rice
- mixed vegetables
- cashew paste
- spices

Optional Ingredients

- raisins
- coriander

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
cashew paste	coconut milk

Instructions

364. Prepare vegetable korma as a thick curry using cashew paste and spices.
365. Serve over a bowl of steamed rice.
366. Garnish with coriander.

Cooking Tips

- A convenient bowl-format twist on a traditional curry-and-rice meal.

R096 · Peanut Chutney

South Indian | *vegan, vegetarian, gluten-free, dairy-free*

Prep / Cook Time: 10 min prep, 5 min cook

Servings: 4

Core Ingredients

- roasted peanuts
- garlic
- tamarind
- red chili

Optional Ingredients

- curry leaves

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
tamarind	lemon juice

Instructions

367. Blend peanuts, garlic, tamarind, red chili and salt with a little water until smooth.
368. Temper mustard seeds and curry leaves in oil, pour over chutney.

Cooking Tips

- Adjust water quantity to control chutney consistency — thicker for dosa, thinner for idli.

R097 · Coconut Chutney

South Indian | *vegan, vegetarian, gluten-free, dairy-free*

Prep / Cook Time: 10 min prep, 5 min cook

Servings: 4

Core Ingredients

- fresh coconut
- roasted gram dal
- green chili
- ginger

Optional Ingredients

- curry leaves
- mustard seeds

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
fresh coconut	desiccated coconut soaked in water

Instructions

369. Blend coconut, roasted gram dal, green chili, ginger, and salt with water until smooth.
370. Temper mustard seeds and curry leaves in oil, pour over chutney.

Cooking Tips

- Use fresh coconut for the best flavor; frozen grated coconut also works well.

R098 · Mint Coriander Chutney

Indian | *vegan, vegetarian, gluten-free, dairy-free*

Prep / Cook Time: 10 min prep, 0 min cook

Servings: 4

Core Ingredients

- mint leaves
- coriander leaves
- green chili
- lemon

Optional Ingredients

- yogurt for creamier version

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
yogurt	omit for vegan

Instructions

371. Blend mint, coriander, green chili, lemon juice, and salt with a little water until smooth.
372. Adjust consistency and seasoning to taste.

Cooking Tips

- Adding a small piece of ginger brightens the chutney's flavor.

R099 · Vegetable Kabab (Shami Style)

Indian | *vegetarian, vegan option*

Prep / Cook Time: 15 min prep, 20 min cook

Servings: 3

Core Ingredients

- boiled mixed vegetables/lentils
- besan
- spices

Optional Ingredients

- coriander
- onion

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
besan	breadcrumbs

Instructions

373. Mash boiled vegetables/lentils with besan and spices.
374. Shape into flat patties.
375. Shallow fry on a pan until golden and crisp on both sides.

Cooking Tips

- Chilling patties for 10-15 minutes before frying helps them hold together.

R100 · Vegetable Biryani Rice Salad (Cold)

Fusion | vegetarian, vegan, gluten-free

Prep / Cook Time: 15 min prep, 10 min cook

Servings: 3

Core Ingredients

- cooked rice
- mixed roasted vegetables
- biryani masala
- lemon

Optional Ingredients

- mint
- cashews

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
biryani masala	garam masala

Instructions

376. Toss cooled cooked rice with roasted vegetables and biryani masala.
377. Squeeze lemon juice, garnish with mint and cashews, serve chilled or at room temperature.

Cooking Tips

- A creative cold-salad way to repurpose leftover biryani rice.

R101 · Vegetable Stir Fry (Simple)

International | vegan, vegetarian, gluten-free, dairy-free

Prep / Cook Time: 5 min prep, 10 min cook

Servings: 2

Core Ingredients

- any available vegetables
- garlic
- oil
- soy sauce or salt

Optional Ingredients

- ginger
- chili flakes

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
soy sauce	salt and pepper if unavailable

Instructions

- 378. Heat oil, saute garlic (and ginger if using).
- 379. Add chopped vegetables, stir-fry on high heat until crisp-tender.
- 380. Season with soy sauce or salt and pepper, toss and serve.

Cooking Tips

- A flexible base recipe — works with almost any combination of vegetables on hand.

R102 · Mixed Dal (Panchmel Dal)

Indian | *vegan, vegetarian, gluten-free*

Prep / Cook Time: 10 min prep, 35 min cook

Servings: 4

Core Ingredients

- five mixed lentils
- onion
- tomato
- garlic
- spices

Optional Ingredients

- ghee
- coriander

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
ghee	oil for vegan

Instructions

- 381. Wash and pressure-cook mixed lentils with turmeric until soft.
- 382. Prepare a tempering with garlic, onion, tomato, and spices.
- 383. Pour tempering over cooked lentils, simmer 5-10 minutes, garnish with coriander.

Cooking Tips

- Using a mix of lentils gives a more complex flavor and texture than a single dal.

R103 · Vegetable Pulao (Coconut Milk Version)

Indian | *vegan, vegetarian, gluten-free, dairy-free*

Prep / Cook Time: 15 min prep, 25 min cook

Servings: 4

Core Ingredients

- rice
- mixed vegetables
- coconut milk
- whole spices

Optional Ingredients

- cashews
- curry leaves

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
coconut milk	regular milk (non-vegan) or water with less richness

Instructions

384. Saute whole spices in oil until fragrant.
385. Add vegetables, saute briefly.
386. Add rice and coconut milk instead of water, bring to boil.
387. Cover and simmer until rice is cooked, fluff and serve.

Cooking Tips

- Coconut milk adds richness — reduce added salt slightly since coconut milk can be naturally sweet.

R104 · Egg Fried Noodles

Chinese | *non-vegetarian*

Prep / Cook Time: 10 min prep, 15 min cook

Servings: 3

Core Ingredients

- noodles
- eggs
- garlic
- soy sauce
- spring onion

Optional Ingredients

- mixed vegetables

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
soy sauce	tamari

Instructions

388. Boil noodles, drain and set aside.
389. Scramble eggs lightly, set aside.
390. Saute garlic and vegetables if using, add noodles and soy sauce, toss well.
391. Fold in scrambled egg, garnish with spring onion.

Cooking Tips

- Scrambling eggs separately keeps them in distinct pieces rather than disappearing into the noodles.

R105 · Vegetable Baked Beans on Toast

International | *vegetarian, vegan option*

Prep / Cook Time: 5 min prep, 10 min cook

Servings: 2

Core Ingredients

- baked beans
- bread
- onion

Optional Ingredients

- cheese
- chili flakes

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
baked beans	boiled kidney beans in tomato sauce

Instructions

392. Warm baked beans with sauteed onion.
393. Toast bread slices.
394. Pour beans over toast, top with cheese if using.

Cooking Tips

- A fast, filling meal from mostly pantry-stable ingredients.

R106 · Vegetable Khichdi (One Pot)

Indian | *vegetarian, vegan, gluten-free*

Prep / Cook Time: 10 min prep, 25 min cook

Servings: 3

Core Ingredients

- rice
- mixed lentils
- mixed vegetables
- turmeric
- cumin seeds

Optional Ingredients

- ghee
- ginger

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
ghee	oil

Instructions

395. Wash rice and lentils together.
396. Heat ghee/oil, temper cumin seeds.
397. Add vegetables and turmeric, saute briefly.
398. Add rice-lentil mix and water, pressure cook until soft.
399. Serve hot, optionally with a dollop of ghee.

Cooking Tips

- A nourishing, easily digestible one-pot meal, great for using up various vegetables.

R107 · Sweet Potato Curry

*Indian/Fusion | vegan, vegetarian, gluten-free, dairy-free***Prep / Cook Time:** 15 min prep, 30 min cook**Servings:** 3**Core Ingredients**

- sweet potato
- onion
- tomato
- coconut milk
- spices

Optional Ingredients

- spinach
- coriander

Substitutions

If missing	Use instead
coconut milk	cream

Instructions

400. Saute onion until golden.
401. Add tomato and spices, cook until soft.
402. Add cubed sweet potato and coconut milk, simmer until tender.
403. Stir in spinach if using, garnish and serve.

Cooking Tips

- Sweet potatoes' natural sweetness pairs well with warming spices like cinnamon or cumin.